

Halogen Means “salt former”. A reactive element that forms salts on reacting with metals.

Isotope A form of an element where the atoms have a different number of neutrons.

Melting point The temperature at which a solid turns into a liquid.

Metal A type of element that is often a hard, shiny solid.

Microchip A piece of silicon with electronic computer circuits.

Microscope A device used to see objects that are too small to be seen by the eye.

Mineral A naturally forming solid substance.

Mixture The result of two or more substances physically mixed together.

Molecule A collection of atoms joined together by sharing their electrons.

Nebula A cloud of gas and dust in space.

Neon light A coloured lamp made by passing

electricity through neon mixed with other gases in a glass tube.

Neutron A particle with no electric charge, found in the nucleus of an atom.

Noble gas A gas that does not react with any other element.

Non-metal A solid, liquid, or gaseous element that is not a metal or semi-metal.

Nuclear fission A process in which an atom's nucleus splits in two, releasing a huge amount of energy.

Nuclear reaction A reaction that involves the atomic nucleus of an element.

Nuclear reactor A machine in which controlled nuclear reactions take place.

Nucleus The core of an atom that contains the protons and neutrons.

Ore A mineral that contains a useful element such as a metal.

Organism The scientific term for a life form.

Oxide A compound made of oxygen and another element.

Particle accelerator A machine that makes atoms or subatomic particles travel at high speeds so they can be collided with a target, or be smashed together. A cyclotron is a type of particle accelerator.

Physicist A scientist who studies physics – the field of science concerned with motion, energy, and forces.

Proton A positively charged particle in the nucleus of an atom.

Radioactivity The process in which an atom breaks apart, releasing particles and energy.

Room temperature 20°C (68°F).

Rust A type of corrosion produced when iron reacts with water and oxygen in the air.

Salt A chemical formed when an acid reacts with a metal, an alkali, or a similar substance.

Satellite A body like the Moon or a

spacecraft that orbits Earth or another body in space.

Semiconductor A substance that can either conduct electricity or block it.

Semi-metal A substance with features of both metals and non-metals.

Smelting A process used to extract metals from their ores.

Subatomic particle A particle that is smaller than an atom. Protons, electrons, and neutrons are subatomic particles.

Superheavy element An artificial element that has a very high number of protons.

Supernova An explosion that occurs when a giant star dies.

Turbine A machine that converts a flow of gas or liquid into rotational motion.

Ultraviolet An invisible form of light emitted by the Sun.

X-ray An invisible form of radiation.